

PEOPLE
INFORMED
SOCIETIES
STRONGER



IDEAS
PEOPLE
PROGRESS
A STRONGER INDIA

KNOW
TODAY
BUILD
TOMORROW

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST

07 SEPTEMBER 2026 | DAILY EDITION

IMPORTANT DEVELOPMENTS.
BROADER PERSPECTIVES.

NEWS THAT SHAPES A BETTER TOMORROW.



POLITY &
GOVERNANCE



ECONOMY



INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS



ENVIRONMENT



SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY



AGRICULTURE



GEOGRAPHY



PUBLIC
POLICY

A
VIBRANT
DEMOCRACY
A BRIGHTER
TOMORROW



SCIENCE
SOLUTIONS
A SAFER
TOMORROW

CONSTITUTION
RIGHTS
OPPORTUNITIES
INCLUSION
PROGRESS

CLEANER
GREENER
HEALTHIER
TOMORROW

A MORE INFORMED INDIA
FOR A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

FACTS TODAY. A STRONGER TOMORROW.

INDIA'S VULTURE CONSERVATION FROM CRISIS TO RECOVERY

Healthy Ecosystems | Safer Communities | A Vulture-friendly India

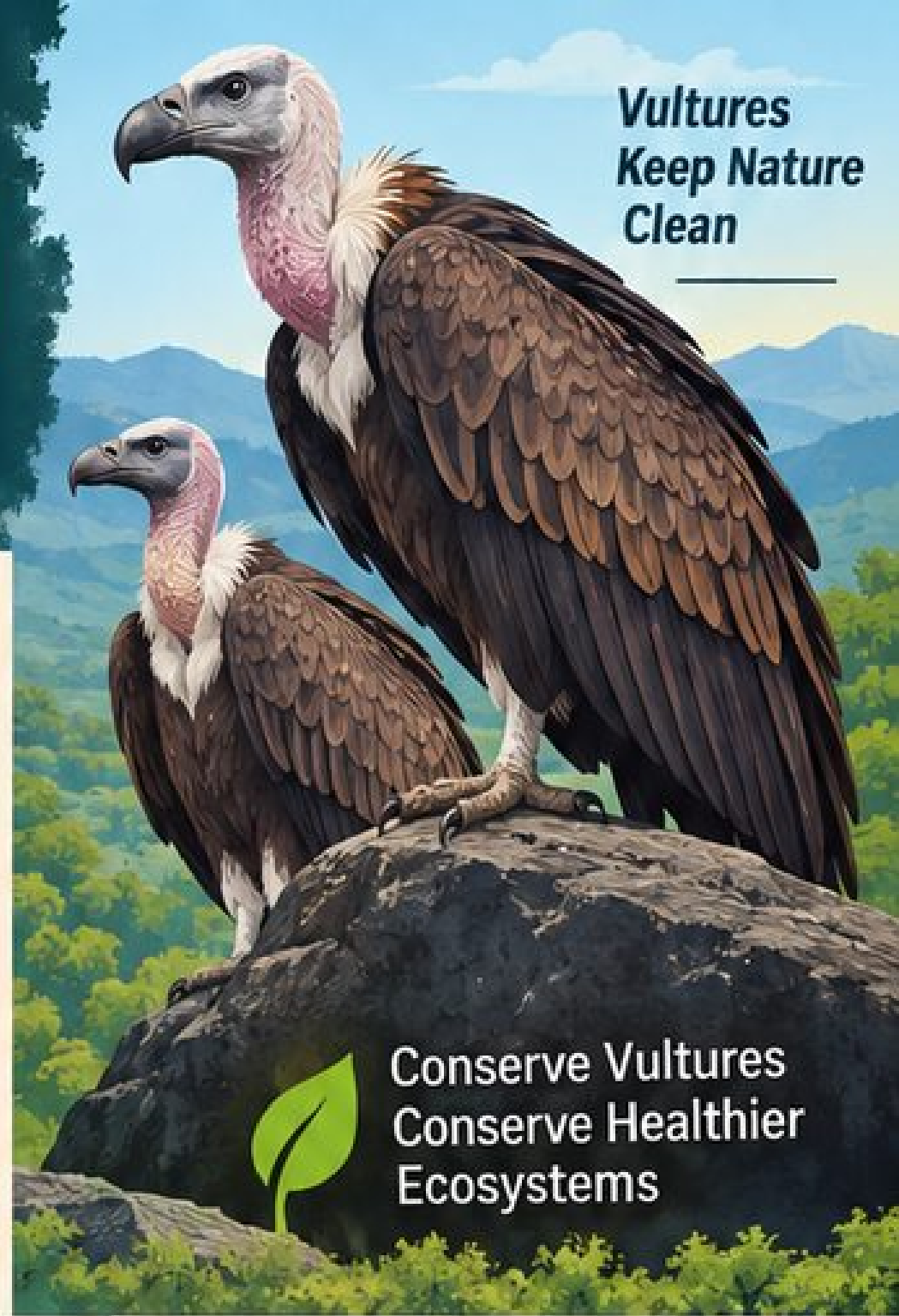
Vultures
Keep Nature
Clean

WHAT'S NEW?

6 September 2026



- Union Environment Minister inaugurated a national workshop at **Panchkula, Haryana** for **International Vulture Awareness Day 2026**.
- Workshop theme: **'From Crisis to Recovery – Conserving India's Vultures'**.
- Call for continued creation of **Vulture Safe Zones** and stronger technical capacity for species recovery in the wild.
- **Organised by:** Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Central Zoo Authority, Haryana Forest & Wildlife Department, Bombay Natural History Society, and Jatayu Conservation Breeding Centre at Pinjore.



WHY VULTURES MATTER



Scavengers rapidly dispose of carcasses.



Reduce disease risk for humans and livestock.



Help in nutrient cycling.



Indicator of ecosystem health.

WHY POPULATIONS CRASHED



Veterinary **diclofenac poisoning** through livestock carcasses was a major driver.



Habitat and food-chain pressures.



Unsafe carcass management and other threats.

VULTURE SAFE ZONE



- A landscape where threats are reduced, especially toxic veterinary drugs.
- Ensures safe food sources and proper carcass management.
- Involves monitoring, community participation and veterinary engagement.

INDIA FACTS

9

India has **nine vulture species**.

Examples:

- White-rumped Vulture
- Indian (Long-billed) Vulture
- Slender-billed Vulture
- Red-headed Vulture
- Egyptian Vulture
- Himalayan Griffon



CONSERVATION TOOLKIT



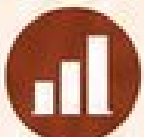
Captive breeding and reintroduction.



Drug safety and veterinary awareness (e.g. ban on diclofenac).



Habitat protection and safe carcass management.



Population monitoring and research.



Community participation and multi-stakeholder action.

PINJORE CENTRE



Jatayu Conservation Breeding Centre (JCBC) at Pinjore, Haryana

- A major conservation-breeding facility for vultures.
- In 2025–26, it housed **356 vultures** and bred **35 chicks**.



PRELIMS BOX



Vultures are birds of prey (raptors) and **scavengers**, not predators of live prey in normal circumstances.



Diclofenac residues in cattle carcasses can cause fatal kidney failure in vultures.



In-situ: Vulture Safe Zones (in the wild).
Ex-situ: Conservation breeding in facilities like JCBC, Pinjore.

Vultures Today
Healthier Tomorrows

SAVE VULTURES
SAVE ECOSYSTEMS
SAVE LIVES



INDIA'S BIODIVERSITY GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

CONSERVE TODAY. THRIVING TOMORROW.

PEOPLE
NATURE
SUSTAINABLE
INDIA

RICH
BIODIVERSITY
STRONGER
COMMUNITIES
A SUSTAINABLE
TOMORROW

BIODIVERSITY
SECURES
OUR FUTURE

WHAT'S NEW?



16th National Meet
held at **Chandigarh**



Focus: implementation
of biodiversity governance
at State & local levels



Brings together State
Biodiversity Boards and
UT Biodiversity Councils

LEGAL BACKBONE



Biological Diversity Act, 2002



Biological Diversity Rules



Access & Benefit Sharing (ABS)



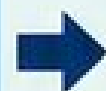
Conservation + sustainable use
+ fair benefit sharing

THREE-TIER INSTITUTIONAL STRUCTURE



National
Biodiversity
Authority (NBA)

NATIONAL LEVEL



State
Biodiversity
Boards (SBBs)

STATE LEVEL



Biodiversity
Management
Committees (BMCs)

LOCAL BODIES

PEOPLE'S BIODIVERSITY REGISTERS



Prepared locally by BMCs



Document local biological
resources



Record traditional knowledge
associated with biodiversity

ACCESS & BENEFIT SHARING



Ensures benefits from use of
biological resources are shared fairly



May include monetary and
non-monetary benefits



Links conservation with
community incentives

PRELIMS FACTS



NBA headquarters: **Chennai**



BMCs are constituted by local bodies



Biological diversity governance links
Centre, States and local institutions



India is a party to the Convention on
Biological Diversity (CBD)

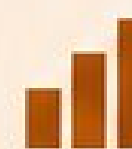
WHY LOCAL GOVERNANCE MATTERS



Conservation is site-specific



Communities hold ecological
and traditional knowledge



Local monitoring improves
implementation

BIODIVERSITY PEOPLE PROSPERITY

NATURE
INDIA
ALWAYS

RBI & EXCESS BANKING LIQUIDITY

WHY TOO MUCH MONEY CAN BE A PROBLEM

MORE LIQUIDITY TODAY. A BALANCED TOMORROW.



STABLE
BANKING
SYSTEM
STRONGER
INDIA

WHAT'S NEW?



₹10.3 lakh crore

Banking system liquidity surplus (as on 3 Sept 2026)

Highest in about four years



RBI using **VRRR** to absorb excess funds



₹6.02 lakh crore

absorbed on 4 Sept 2026 through **VRRR** auctions

WHAT IS LIQUIDITY?



- Funds readily available with banks.
- Surplus liquidity** = banks have more funds than immediate system demand.
- Deficit liquidity** = banks need RBI funding.

WHY EXCESS LIQUIDITY MATTERS



- Can push overnight money-market rates below policy repo rate.



- Weakens monetary-policy transmission.



- May add inflationary pressure if prolonged.



- Requires liquidity sterilisation / absorption.

RBI TOOLKIT TO MANAGE LIQUIDITY



Variable Rate Reverse Repo (VRRR)

Banks park funds with RBI at a variable auction-determined rate.



Standing Deposit Facility (SDF)

Absorbs liquidity without collateral.



Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR)

Portion of deposits kept with RBI (earns no interest).



Open Market Operations (OMO) and forex operations can alter rupee liquidity.

MONETARY POLICY CORRIDOR

Higher rate

MSF

(Marginal Standing Facility)

Upper bound of the corridor

Repo Rate

Policy signal (mid-point)

Lower rate

SDF

(Standing Deposit Facility)

Lower bound of the corridor

WACR (Weighted Average Call Rate) is RBI's operating target.

PRELIMS FACTS



Repo injects liquidity against collateral (to banks).



Reverse repo / VRRR-type operations absorb liquidity.



CRR balances earn no interest.



Sterilisation offsets the liquidity impact of forex intervention.

HOW FOREX INFLOWS LEAD TO EXCESS LIQUIDITY



Foreign currency inflows



RBI buys dollars (in forex market)



Rupees enter the banking system



Banking liquidity rises

Absorption tools (VRRR, SDF, CRR, OMO) pull surplus rupees back from the system.

SOUND MONEY. A STRONGER TOMORROW.

INDIA'S 3-YEAR ROADMAP FOR A DRUG-FREE INDIA

SAFER PEOPLE | STRONGER COMMUNITIES | A HEALTHIER NATION

SAY NO TO DRUGS
BUILD A BRIGHTER INDIA

1 WHAT'S NEW?



3-year roadmap:

July 2026 → July 2029



Goal: stronger national action against drug trafficking and substance abuse



Enforcement + coordination + prevention + rehabilitation

2 INDIA'S ANTI-DRUG ARCHITECTURE



Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB)

- Central coordinating and enforcement agency



Ministry of Home Affairs

- Key nodal ministry for narcotics control



State police and anti-narcotics units

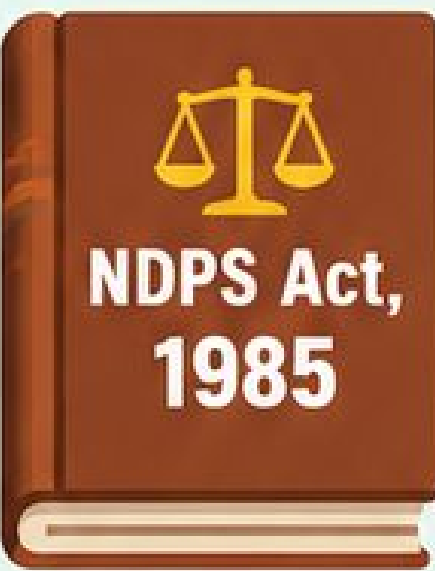
- Ground enforcement



Multi-agency coordination is essential

- Trafficking crosses borders and jurisdictions

3 LEGAL BACKBONE



- Controls and regulates narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances
- Provides stringent penalties for illicit trafficking
- Also permits regulated medical/scientific use under law

4 FOUR-PILLAR RESPONSE



Supply reduction

Disrupt trafficking networks



Demand reduction

Prevention and awareness



Treatment & rehabilitation

Support people with substance-use disorders



International cooperation

Intelligence and border coordination

5 WHY DRUG TRAFFICKING IS A SECURITY ISSUE



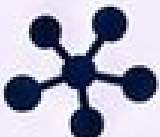
Organised crime networks



Cross-border trafficking



Money laundering and illicit finance



Potential links with other transnational crimes

6 PRELIMS FACTS



NCB established in 1986



NDPS = Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances



India is located between the **Golden Crescent** and **Golden Triangle** trafficking regions



Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan focuses on demand reduction and awareness

7 TRAFFICKING GEOGRAPHY

India's location makes it vulnerable due to proximity to two major illicit drug production regions.



Golden Crescent and Golden Triangle are major global centres of illicit drug production and trafficking.

SECURE BORDERS
SAFER TOMORROW

WESTERN ZONAL COUNCIL

CENTRE – STATE COORDINATION & COOPERATIVE FEDERALISM

DIALOGUE | COOPERATION | STRONGER STATES | A STRONGER INDIA

PANAJI
GOA

7 SEPT 2026

Stronger
Together
for a
Developed India



WHAT'S NEW?



28th Western Zonal Council meeting



Panaji, Goa — 7 Sept 2026



Platform for Centre–State and inter-State coordination



ZONAL COUNCILS

- Created under the **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**
- Statutory bodies — **NOT constitutional bodies**
- Five zonal councils: Northern, Central, Eastern, Western, Southern
- North Eastern Council is separate and governed by the NEC Act, 1971



WESTERN ZONAL COUNCIL MEMBERS

- Goa
- Gujarat
- Maharashtra
- Union Territory of Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu



WHO CHAIRS?

- Union Home Minister: common Chairman of the five Zonal Councils
- Chief Ministers of member States: Vice-Chairman by annual rotation
- Administrators/LG of member UTs participate



WHAT DO THEY DISCUSS?

- Inter-State issues
- Border, transport and infrastructure coordination
- Internal security
- Social and economic planning
- Implementation of national programmes



WHY THEY MATTER



Cooperative federalism



Consultation before conflict



Regional coordination



Faster resolution of shared administrative problems



PRELIMS TRAPS

- Zonal Councils ≠ Inter-State Council
- Inter-State Council: **Article 263** of Constitution
- Zonal Councils: **States Reorganisation Act, 1956**
- NEC is not one of the five Zonal Councils

7 SEPT 2026
NEW DELHI

A STRONGER PARTNERSHIP
FOR A STABLE AND PROSPEROUS
INDO-PACIFIC

PEACE
PROSPERITY
PEOPLE
PLANET

15th INDIA-JAPAN ANNUAL SUMMIT

STRONGER TIES FOR A SHARED FUTURE

 **WHEN & WHERE**
7 September 2026
New Delhi, India

 **LEADERS**
Prime Minister
Narendra Modi
& Prime Minister
Shigeru Ishiba

 **SIGNIFICANCE**
Reviewed progress,
set new goals and
reaffirmed commitment
to a free, open, inclusive
and rules-based
Indo-Pacific



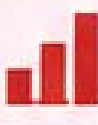
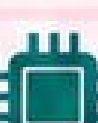
KEY OUTCOMES

 ENHANCED STRATEGIC COOPERATION Reaffirmed Special Strategic and Global Partnership	 ECONOMIC & INVESTMENT TIES Focus on resilient supply chains, clean energy, infrastructure and emerging technologies	 DEFENCE & SECURITY Greater collaboration in maritime security, cyber, space and defence industry	 GREEN & CLEAN ENERGY Cooperation on renewable energy, hydrogen, energy efficiency and climate action	 PEOPLE-TO-PEOPLE EXCHANGES Boost in education, skill development, tourism and cultural ties
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INDIA-JAPAN RELATIONS

- 1952 Establishment of diplomatic relations
- 2000 'Global Partnership'
- 2006 'Strategic and Global Partnership'
- 2014 Special Strategic and Global Partnership
- 2016 India-Japan Civil Nuclear Agreement
- 2017 Annual Summit mechanism
- 2022 70 years of diplomatic relations
- 2026 15th Annual Summit

MAJOR AREAS OF COOPERATION

-  **Trade & Investment**
Japan is a major source of FDI in India
-  **Infrastructure**
Flagship project: Mumbai-Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail (Bullet Train)
-  **Technology & Innovation**
Semiconductors, AI, digital, start-ups
-  **Maritime Cooperation**
Peace, security and stability in the Indo-Pacific
-  **Sustainable Development**
Clean energy, green hydrogen, resilient supply chains

 **INDO-PACIFIC VISION**
Both nations reiterated their commitment to a free, open, inclusive and rules-based Indo-Pacific, with respect for international law and freedom of navigation.



TWO DEMOCRACIES.
A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

SMALL MODULAR REACTORS FOR ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ?

CLEAN ENERGY | STRONGER ISLANDS | A SECURE INDO-PACIFIC

SITE ASSESSMENT / PROPOSAL

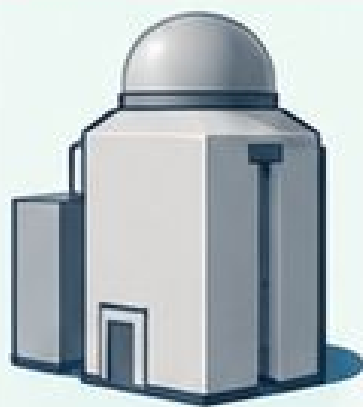
NOT YET AN OPERATING REACTOR

WHAT'S NEW?



- DAE/BARC team assessing sites across Andaman & Nicobar Islands
- Site assessments: **4–8 Sept 2026**
- Purpose: examine nuclear options for future island power demand

WHAT IS AN SMR ?



- **Small Modular Reactor**
- Typically up to **~300 MW(e)** per module
- Factory-fabricated modules can reduce on-site construction time
- Designed for scalable deployment

WHY ISLANDS ?



- Isolated grids
- High dependence on transported fuels
- Growing infrastructure and strategic power needs
- Need reliable low-carbon baseload alongside renewables/storage

INDIA'S NUCLEAR GOVERNANCE



सत्यमेव जयते

- | | |
|--------------|--|
| DAE | Department of Atomic Energy (Union government) |
| BARC | Nuclear R&D |
| NPCIL | Major nuclear power plant operator |
| AERB | Nuclear and radiation safety regulator |

STRATEGIC GEOGRAPHY



SMR: PROMISE vs CHALLENGES

PROMISE



Lower-carbon firm power



Modular scaling



Potential fit for smaller grids

CHALLENGES



Safety & regulation



Radioactive waste management



High upfront economics



Island ecology & disaster resilience

PRELIMS FACTS



Nuclear energy is a Union List subject.



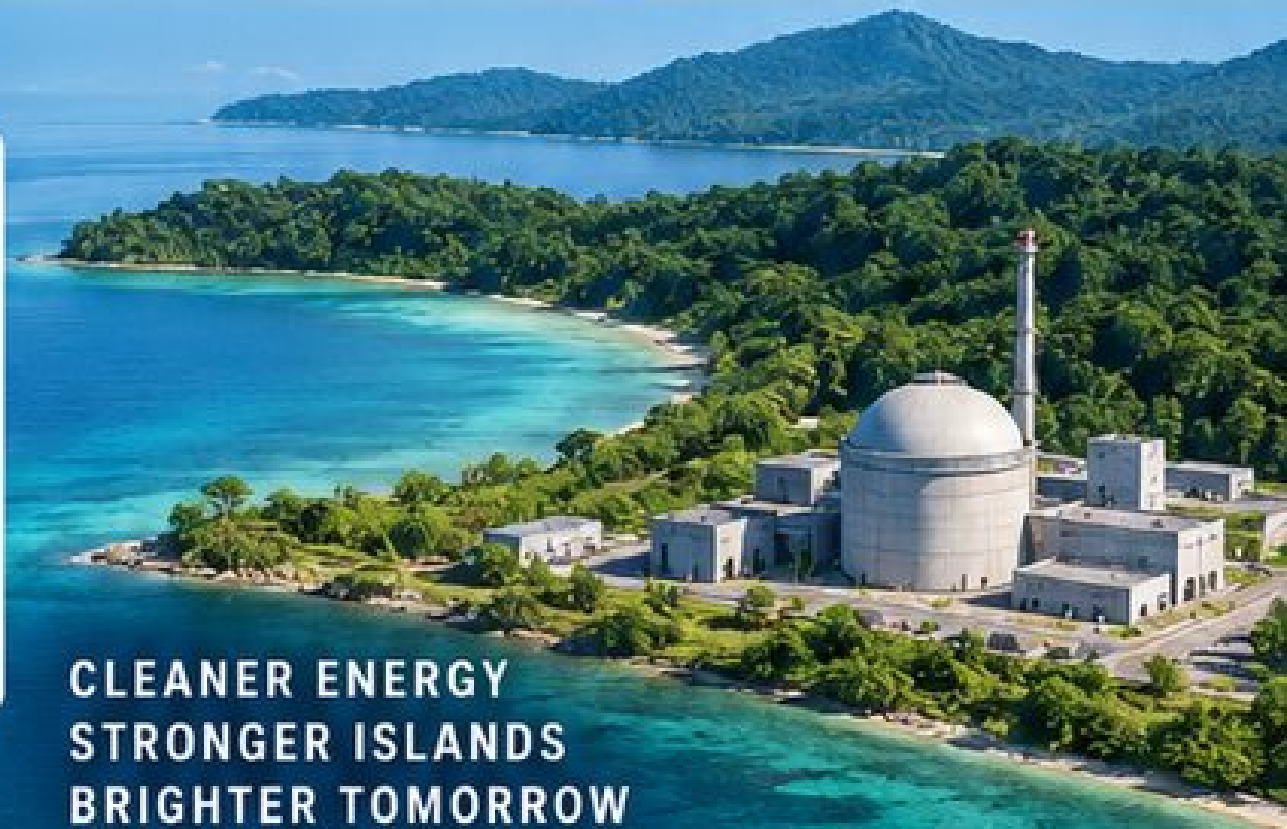
Atomic Energy Act, 1962 is a key law.



Fission releases energy by splitting heavy atomic nuclei.



SMR ≠ nuclear fusion.



CLEANER ENERGY
STRONGER ISLANDS
BRIGHTER TOMORROW

GST 2.0

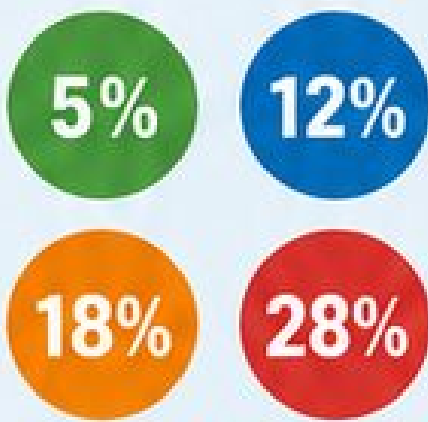
NEXT-GENERATION REFORM FOR A SIMPLER, FAIRER AND STRONGER ECONOMY

The GST Council has approved a simplified two-rate structure, sweeping rate rationalisation and key changes effective from **22 September 2026**.

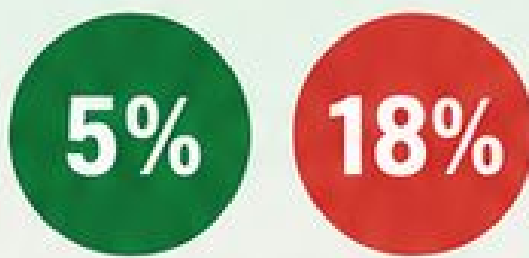


FROM FOUR RATES TO TWO A SIMPLER GST STRUCTURE

EARLIER



NOW



Higher 40% rate only for sin goods (e.g. tobacco, pan masala, luxury items)

WHAT CHANGES?

- Rate rationalisation across a large number of items
- Several goods and services shifted from 12% and 28% to 5% or 18%
- Aim to reduce classification disputes and compliance burden
- Expected to boost consumption, manufacturing and formalisation

GOODS AND SERVICES NOW AT 0%

- Specified lifesaving drugs and rare disease medicines
- Specified defence items
- Select educational materials

A separate list of 0% items has been notified.

WHAT GETS CHEAPER? LOWER TAX ON EVERYDAY ESSENTIALS

- Food items**
Many daily use items moved to 5%
- Healthcare**
Greater relief on medicines and medical devices
- Education**
Select items and services at 5%
- Agriculture**
Inputs and equipment cheaper
- Automobiles**
Small cars and two-wheelers attract lower tax

EXPECTED IMPACT

- Lower prices for households
- Higher demand and economic growth
- Support to MSMEs and job creation
- More competitive and self-reliant India

IMPLEMENTATION

- New rates effective from **22 September 2026**
- Detailed notifications and item-wise lists to be issued by the Government

INDIA-ASEAN SUMMIT 2026

STRONGER PARTNERSHIP FOR A STABLE, PROSPEROUS INDO-PACIFIC

India and ASEAN leaders held the 22nd India-ASEAN Summit, reaffirming their commitment to a peaceful, secure and rules-based Indo-Pacific.

22nd INDIA-ASEAN SUMMIT



7 September 2026



New Delhi, India



Leaders of all 10 ASEAN countries and the Prime Minister of India



22nd INDIA - ASEAN SUMMIT

7 SEPTEMBER 2026, NEW DELHI

ASEAN-India
A Partnership for Peace,
Progress and People



THEME

“ASEAN-India: A Partnership for Peace,
Progress and People”



PARTICIPATION

10 ASEAN member countries +
Prime Minister of India



KEY OUTCOMES

- Adopted a Joint Statement to further deepen the **Comprehensive Strategic Partnership**
- Reaffirmed commitment to a free, open, inclusive and rules-based Indo-Pacific
- Agreed to enhance cooperation in trade, connectivity, maritime security, digital transformation, clean energy, health and people-to-people ties
- Discussed regional and global issues of mutual interest



FOCUS AREAS



Trade & Investment



Maritime Security & Blue Economy



Digital Transformation &
Emerging Technologies



Green Transition & Clean Energy



People-to-People and
Cultural Exchanges



Counter-Terrorism, Cybersecurity
and Transnational Crime

WHAT IS ASEAN?

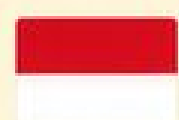
Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) is a regional organisation of 10 Southeast Asian countries, established in 1967 to promote peace, stability and economic cooperation in the region.



Brunei



Cambodia



Indonesia



Laos



Malaysia



Myanmar



Philippines



Singapore



Thailand



Vietnam



A stronger
India-ASEAN
partnership
contributes to a
more peaceful,
prosperous and
inclusive
Indo-Pacific.

INDIA–MAURITIUS ELEVATE TIES TO ENHANCED STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP

During the Mauritius Prime Minister's visit to India (4–9 September 2026), the two countries announced the elevation of bilateral ties to an **"Enhanced Strategic Partnership"**.



WHAT HAPPENED?

- India and Mauritius decided to upgrade their relationship to an **Enhanced Strategic Partnership**.
- Several agreements and MoUs signed across key areas of cooperation.
- Reaffirmed commitment to a free, open, inclusive and secure **Indian Ocean Region**.



*Stronger partners
for a stable, prosperous
Indian Ocean*



KEY AREAS OF COOPERATION



Maritime
Security &
Coastal Surveillance



Trade,
Investment &
Blue Economy



Digital Public
Infrastructure
& Innovation



Climate Change,
Disaster Resilience
& Renewable Energy



People-to-People
Ties, Education
& Capacity Building



SIGNIFICANCE

- Builds on a long-standing and close friendship.
- Strengthens cooperation in the Indian Ocean, a key region for India's security and economic interests.
- Supports Mauritius' development priorities and India's **MAHASAGAR vision** (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions).



ABOUT MAURITIUS

- Island nation in the Indian Ocean, east of Madagascar.
- Strategic location along key maritime sea lanes.
- A close and trusted partner of India with strong people-to-people links (large Indian-origin population).
- Important for India's vision of a stable, secure and prosperous Indian Ocean Region.



**STRONGER INDIA–MAURITIUS TIES
FOR A PEACEFUL, INCLUSIVE AND PROSPEROUS INDIAN OCEAN**



FRONT-OF-PACK FOOD WARNING LABELS

INDIA'S POLICY DEBATE

HEALTHIER
PEOPLE
STRONGER
INDIA



WHAT'S NEW?



Supreme Court challenge to proposed food-warning framework filed by a public-health group (7 September 2026).



Issue: threshold design for front-of-pack warnings.



Hearing reported for 10 September 2026.

HOW THE PROPOSAL WORKS

Red warning proposed when at least 2 of 3 exceed limits:



Added sugar



Salt / Sodium



Saturated fat

Debate: should one excessive nutrient alone trigger a warning?

WHY FRONT-OF-PACK LABELLING?



Quick consumer information.



Supports healthier choices.



Targets diet-related non-communicable diseases (NCDs).



Complements detailed nutrition panels.

GOVERNANCE



FSSAI regulates food safety and standards.



Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.



Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.



Supreme Court reviewing the challenge.



FOOD SAFETY
A HEALTHIER NATION
A STRONGER TOMORROW

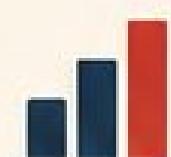
PUBLIC POLICY BALANCE



Consumer right to information.



Public health.



Scientific threshold-setting.



Compliance burden and food-industry impact.

PRELIMS FACTS

- FSSAI = Food Safety and Standards Authority of India.
- FSSAI is a statutory body.
- Food safety is governed principally by the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.
- NCDs include cardiovascular disease, diabetes and some cancers.

GLOBAL CONCEPT



- Front-of-pack labels may use warnings, symbols or nutrient scores.
- Goal: make nutrition risk easier to understand at purchase.

Examples globally: warning labels (e.g., high in sugar), traffic light systems, or nutrient scores (e.g., Nutri-Score).



PROPOSAL UNDER COURT REVIEW
NOT A FINAL SUPREME COURT RULING

A HEALTHIER
FOOD ENVIRONMENT
BUILDS A HEALTHIER
TOMORROW

CURRENT AFFAIRS

WEDNESDAY

09

SEPTEMBER 2026

Facts
Today
for a Brighter
Tomorrow

DAILY DIGEST

KEY DEVELOPMENTS | BIGGER PICTURE | A MORE INFORMED YOU



POLITY &
GOVERNANCE



Governance
Reforms, Policies
and Institutions



ECONOMY



Markets, Industry,
Trade and
Growth Trends



INTERNATIONAL
RELATIONS



Global Developments,
Strategic Partnerships
and Geopolitics



ENVIRONMENT



Climate Action,
Biodiversity and
Sustainable Development



SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY



Innovation,
Research and
a Brighter Future



AGRICULTURE



Farming, Food Security
and Rural Development



GEOGRAPHY



Places, People
and the Changing
World



MISCELLANEOUS



People, Society,
Health, Education,
Culture and More

A MORE INFORMED
A BRIGHTER TOMORROW

CURIOSITY

KNOWLEDGE

PERSPECTIVE

PROGRESS

KHARIF SOWING 2026

PADDY AREA DOWN 4%

AS MONSOON DEFICIT BITES

Uneven rainfall leads to lower paddy area, raises yield risks for pulses and oilseeds, but large rice stocks provide a buffer.

WHAT HAPPENED?



PADDY AREA (2026)

42.18 million hectares
↓ 4% (year-on-year)



TOTAL KHARIF AREA

108.63 million hectares
↓ 1.6% (year-on-year)



Deficient and uneven monsoon rainfall is a key factor behind the lower paddy area and overall kharif sowing.

CROP PICTURE (AREA UNDER SOWING)



PULSES

11.71 million hectares
↑ Increased (year-on-year)



OILSEEDS

19.19 million hectares
↓ Slightly lower (year-on-year)

Area coverage does not equal final production. Yields depend on rainfall distribution, irrigation, pests and weather during crop development.

MONSOON → AGRICULTURE LINK



Rainfall affects sowing timing, soil moisture, reservoir recharge and crop yields.



Uneven spatial and temporal distribution can be as important as the all-India seasonal total.



A ~14.4% monsoon rainfall deficit has been reported, with uneven spread across regions.

FOOD SECURITY BUFFER

70.86 million tonnes

Government's kharif paddy procurement target (2026).



Large public rice stocks can cushion near-term supply risk. Procurement and buffer stocks support the food-security system.

PRELIMS FACTS

- Kharif crops are generally sown with the southwest monsoon and harvested in autumn.
- Major kharif crops: rice, maize, cotton, soybean, groundnut and several pulses.
- MSP is announced before sowing seasons for notified crops.
- FCI maintains central pool foodgrain stocks.

MAINS ANGLE



Climate-resilient agriculture requires:

- Irrigation efficiency
- Drought-tolerant varieties
- Crop diversification
- Better weather advisories
- Water budgeting
- Region-specific cropping choices

WATCH NEXT



Monsoon distribution



Reservoir levels



Crop yields



Food inflation



Procurement arrivals



9 SEPT 2026

HEALTHY CHILDREN
HEALTHY FAMILIES
A BRIGHTER INDIA



NOURISHED
COMMUNITIES
STRONGER
TOMORROWS

9th RASHTRIYA POSHAN MAAH 2026

NUTRITION THROUGH COMMUNITY ACTION

Sahi
Poshan
Saksham
Bharat

India launches the ninth Rashtriya Poshan Maah on 9 September 2026 in Varanasi. Observed every September since 2018, this month-long campaign mobilises communities around nutrition, health and caregiving behaviours.



WHAT IS POSHAN MAAH?

- Annual September campaign for nutrition awareness and behaviour change
- Mobilises communities at the grassroots
- 9th edition in 2026



WHO IS AT THE CENTRE?

- Pregnant women
- Lactating mothers
- Children (0–6 years)
- Adolescents
- Families
- Anganwadi Centres as frontline community institutions



CORE THEMES

- Balanced and protein-rich diets
- Maternal nutrition
- Infant and young child feeding
- Growth monitoring
- Hygiene and healthy practices



POLICY ECOSYSTEM

- POSHAN Abhiyaan launched in 2018
- Mission Saksham Anganwadi & Poshan 2.0 integrates nutrition support, early childhood care and Anganwadi strengthening
- Ministry of Women and Child Development is the nodal Union ministry



PRELIMS FACTS

- Anganwadi Services originated under ICDS
- Frontline workers include Anganwadi Workers and Helpers
- Nutrition outcomes require convergence across health, sanitation, drinking water and food systems



MEASURE PROGRESS

- Stunting (low height for age)
- Wasting (low weight for height)
- Underweight (low weight for age)
- Anaemia (across age groups)



MAINS ANGLE

Malnutrition is multidimensional: food quality and diversity, maternal health, sanitation, disease burden, women's agency, household income and effective last-mile delivery all matter.

BETTER NUTRITION → BETTER LEARNING → STRONGER HUMAN CAPITAL

India's Semiconductor Mission

6 New Projects Approved on 9 September 2026

A major boost to India's chip manufacturing ecosystem, adding ~₹1.6 lakh crore in investment and strengthening the goal of a self-reliant electronics supply chain.



6 PROJECTS AT A GLANCE



Total investment
~₹1.6 lakh crore



Expected direct jobs
~7,000

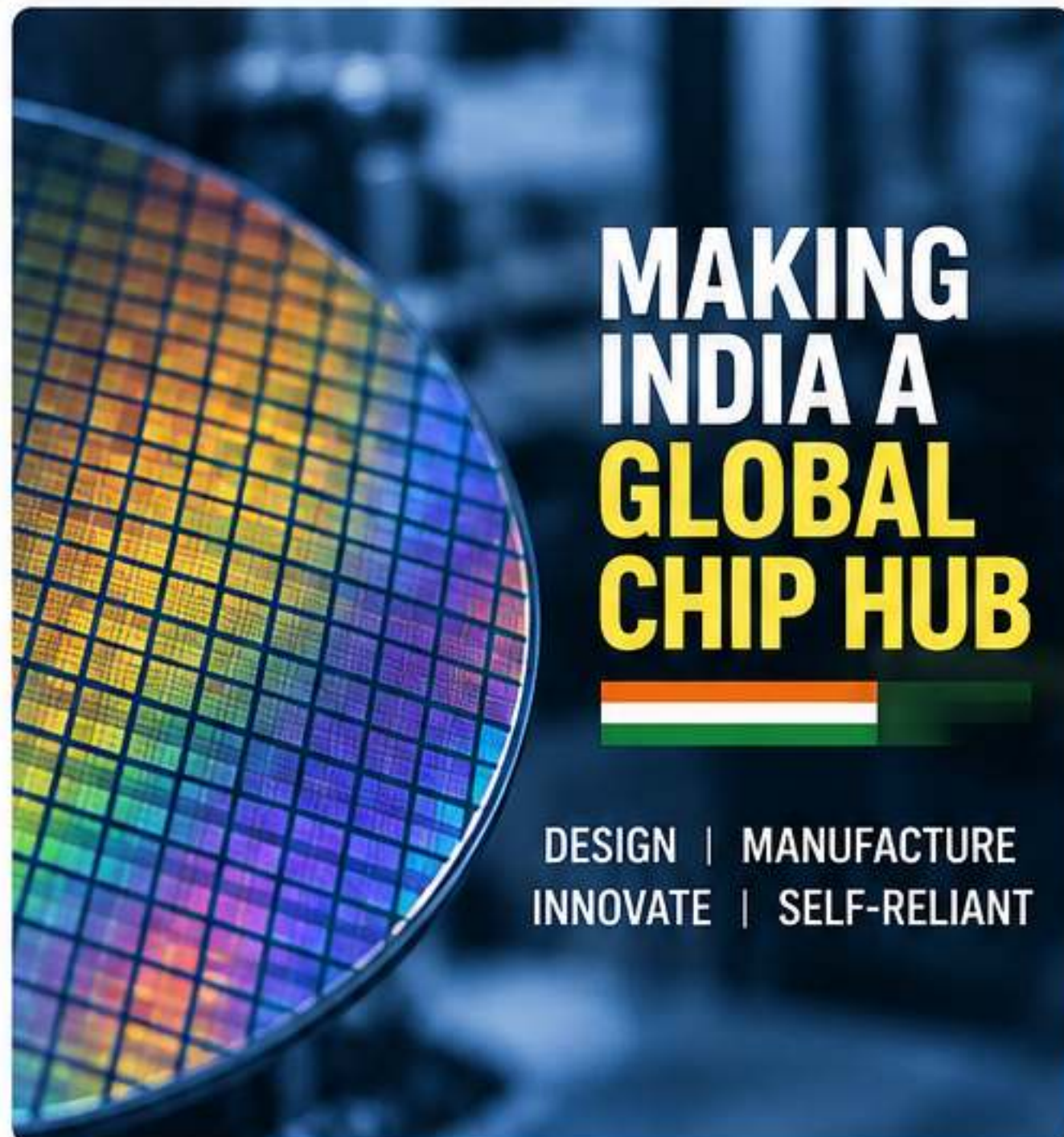


Indirect jobs
~34,000



Spread across
5 states

(Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Karnataka, Punjab and Uttar Pradesh)



DESIGN | MANUFACTURE
INNOVATE | SELF-RELIANT

WHAT WILL BE SET UP?



Semiconductor fabs (2 projects)

Manufacturing of chips for a wide range of applications



ATMP units (3 projects)

Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging



Compound semiconductor unit (1 project)

For next-generation electronics, high-power and high-frequency devices



Focus areas

- Consumer electronics
- Automotive
- Industrial electronics
- Telecom and 5G/6G
- AI and high-performance computing

PART OF A LARGER VISION



- Under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM)
- Aims to build a resilient and self-reliant semiconductor ecosystem
- Attracts global and domestic investment
- Supports India's growing electronics manufacturing and digital economy

RECENT MILESTONES



- With these 6 projects, total approved projects under ISM now **10**
- Cumulative investment: **~₹1.76 lakh crore**
- Positions India as a key player in the global semiconductor value chain

SEMICONDUCTORS
POWER A **SMARTER,**
STRONGER, SELF-RELIANT INDIA



FCI MODERNISATION 2026-27

OUTCOME-BASED FOODGRAIN MANAGEMENT

Stronger Systems | Safer Food | A More Food-Secure India

9 SEPT 2026

From
Grain Security
to a Stronger
Tomorrow

WHAT CHANGED?

Department of Food and Public Distribution (DFPD) and Food Corporation of India (FCI) signed an MoU for **FY 2026-27**, creating an **outcome-oriented performance framework** with defined annual targets for FCI to improve operational efficiency, accountability and modernisation in foodgrain management.



SIX PRIORITY AREAS



Reduce
storage
losses



Optimise
warehouse
capacity



Improve
logistics and
supply chains



Strengthen
quality
control



Digitise business
processes and
monitoring



Train personnel
for modern
systems

FCI IN INDIA'S FOOD SECURITY SYSTEM



Procures foodgrains at **MSP**
operations as assigned by government



Maintains **Central Pool** stocks



Stores and moves foodgrains
across India



Supplies grain for the **Public Distribution System** and other
welfare schemes

POLICY LINKAGES



National Food Security Act, 2013
provides legal entitlements to subsidised
foodgrains for eligible beneficiaries



Central Pool stocks support
distribution and food-security
management



Buffer norms help ensure operational
and strategic availability

WHY MODERNISATION MATTERS

- ✓ Lower wastage and better grain preservation
- ✓ Better inventory visibility
- ✓ Faster movement from surplus to deficit regions
- ✓ Improved grain quality and food safety
- ✓ Lower carrying and logistics costs
- ✓ Greater transparency and accountability

PRELIMS FACTS

- FCI was established in **1965** under the **Food Corporations Act, 1964**.
- Administrative ministry: **Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution**.
- DFPD** is a department under that ministry.

MANS ANGLE

Food security depends not only on production and procurement but also efficient storage, scientific handling, logistics, digital traceability, fiscal sustainability and timely last-mile delivery.

RUPEE BREACHES ₹95/\$

OIL SHOCK TESTS INDIA'S EXTERNAL STABILITY

Rupee weakens past 95 per dollar as crude prices surge and global uncertainty deepens.

WHAT HAPPENED?



- Indian rupee breached ₹95 per US dollar, touching about 95.2250 on 9 Sept 2026.



- Brent crude moved towards \$100 per barrel amid escalating Middle East tensions and supply-disruption fears.



- Rupee was the worst-performing Asian currency during the session.



- RBI is understood to have intervened in the forex market, but external dollar demand and oil pressures overwhelmed support.

RBI'S TOOLKIT



Forex-market intervention using reserves to manage volatility.



Liquidity management and monetary-policy signalling.



RBI generally manages excessive volatility rather than defending a permanently fixed exchange rate.

PRELIMS FACTS

- India follows a market-determined exchange-rate system with RBI intervention (to manage excessive volatility).
- Forex reserves include foreign currency assets, gold, SDRs and India's reserve position with the IMF.
- The current account (CAD) is a component of the Balance of Payments (BoP).

MAINS ANGLE

- Greater resilience requires diversified energy sources and higher domestic renewable capacity.
- Prudent external borrowing and adequate forex buffers.
- Competitive exports to strengthen the current account.
- A credible and consistent macroeconomic policy framework is essential.

WATCH NEXT

- Brent crude price trend
- RBI intervention
- Forex reserves level
- Current-account deficit (CAD)
- Imported inflation data



WHY OIL HITS THE RUPEE?



India imports around 85% of its crude oil needs.



Higher oil prices increase the import bill and demand for dollars.



This can widen the current-account deficit (CAD) and put pressure on the rupee.



Rupee depreciation can make imports costlier and feed into domestic inflation.

EXTERNAL-SECTOR CHAIN



INDIA'S SPONGE IRON PRICES HIT 2-YEAR HIGH

COAL SUPPLY SHOCK HITS STEEL CHAIN

HIGHER COAL COSTS.
TIGHTER SUPPLY.
BIGGER IMPACT.



WHAT HAPPENED?

India's benchmark sponge iron price reached about **₹29,700 per tonne** in August 2026, its **highest in two years**, as imported coal became more expensive and domestic coal availability tightened.

WHAT IS SPONGE IRON?

Sponge iron, or Direct Reduced Iron (DRI), is made by reducing iron ore below its melting point. It is an important feedstock for **secondary steelmaking**, especially in electric and induction furnaces.

Solid-state reduction (rather than melting) makes it different from pig iron produced in a blast furnace.



WHY COAL MATTERS

- Many Indian DRI plants use **non-coking coal** as a reducing agent and fuel.
- Imported coal costs have risen due to higher freight and insurance costs amid Middle East tensions.
- Domestic coal supply tightened as coal was prioritised for power generation during high summer demand.
- Monsoon rains also disrupted mining operations and rail logistics.

INDIA'S POSITION

India is the world's largest sponge iron producer, with about **336 plants** producing around **50 million tonnes** annually.



ECONOMIC TRANSMISSION



ENERGY-INDUSTRY TRADE-OFF

Prioritising coal for electricity security can tighten industrial supply, highlighting the challenge of balancing power demand with the needs of steel and other industries. It also underscores the need for better logistics and fuel diversification.



PRELIMS FACTS

- ✓ Coking coal is mainly used in blast-furnace steelmaking.
- ✓ Non-coking coal can be used in coal-based DRI.
- ✓ DRI uses solid-state reduction, unlike pig iron produced through melting in a blast furnace.

MAINS ANGLE

Resilient steel supply chains need better domestic coal logistics, energy efficiency, gas and green-hydrogen DRI pathways, recycling and lower-carbon production while maintaining affordable industrial inputs.

WATCH NEXT



Coal imports



Rail availability



Steel prices



Power demand



Green-hydrogen DRI

ENERGY INPUTS →
INDUSTRIAL COSTS →
INFRASTRUCTURE & MANUFACTURING



A STRONGER
INDIA
BUILDS
TOMORROW

SUGAR SUPPLY POLICY

DUTY-FREE RAW SUGAR IMPORTS & EARLY CRUSHING

STABLE SUPPLY
FOR A SWEETER
TOMORROW

Government allows duty-free imports of 1 million tonnes of raw sugar and asks mills to start crushing on 15 October to cool record-high domestic prices.

WHAT CHANGED?



Duty-free raw sugar import quota: **1 million tonnes**



Port refineries can seek quota to sell refined sugar domestically



Around **250,000 tonnes** of quota applications expected from refineries



Sugar mills asked to start crushing on **15 October**, nearly a month earlier than usual

WHY GOVERNMENT INTERVENED



Record-high domestic sugar prices



Rising demand during festival season



Need to augment near-term supply



Moderate food inflation

HOW THE SUPPLY CHAIN WORKS



Imports can supplement domestic output when supplies are tight.

SUGAR POLICY TOOLKIT



Import duties / quotas



Export controls



Monthly release mechanisms



Crushing-season timing



Ethanol diversion policy (from sugarcane/ molasses)



Stock monitoring and buffer management

ECONOMY LINK



Sugar prices affect food inflation (CPI).



Sugarcane supports farm incomes and rural employment.



Diversion to ethanol creates a food-versus-fuel allocation trade-off.

PRELIMS FACTS



Sugarcane is a long-duration tropical/subtropical crop.



Major producing states: Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Karnataka.



India is among the world's largest sugar producers and consumers.



Ethanol can be produced from sugarcane juice, B-heavy molasses and other feedstocks (subject to policy).

MAINS ANGLE



A stable sugar policy requires balancing consumer prices, farmer cane dues, mill viability, ethanol blending, water use and predictable trade policy.



WATCH NEXT

- Retail sugar prices
- Import arrivals and domestic offtake
- Progress of October crushing
- Cane output estimates
- Ethanol allocation decisions

FROM FIELDS TO MARKETS
A STRONGER, MORE RESILIENT
SUGAR ECOSYSTEM

FARM INCOME ↔ FOOD PRICES ↔ ETHANOL ↔ TRADE POLICY

FRONT-OF-PACK FOOD

WARNING LABELS

INDUSTRY CHALLENGES

FSSAI PLAN IN SUPREME COURT

Health warnings on packaged foods are now at the centre of a major legal and policy debate in India.

SUPREME COURT

TO REVIEW

LABELLING PROPOSAL

WHAT HAPPENED?

- India’s packaged-food industry has filed its first major legal objection to the government’s proposed front-of-pack warning-label system.
 - The Supreme Court will review the matter.

PROPOSED LABEL SYSTEM

- Red hexagon warning on the front of pack.
 - Triggered when a product exceeds limits in at least two of three categories:



ADDED SUGAR



SALT



SATURATED FAT



GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

- FSSAI sets food-safety and labelling standards under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.
 - Ministry of Health & Family Welfare is the administrative ministry.
 - Courts can review whether regulations comply with constitutional and statutory requirements.

FOOD SAFETY

AND STANDARDS

ACT, 2006

PUBLIC HEALTH LOGIC

- Clearer front-of-pack warnings can help consumers identify products high in salt, sugar and saturated fat.
 - Linked to obesity, diabetes, hypertension and other non-communicable disease risks.



HEALTHIER FOOD ENVIRONMENTS

CAN REDUCE NCD BURDEN

INDUSTRY’S ARGUMENT

- Proposed thresholds may be overly stringent.
 - Seeks a per-serving approach rather than per-100-gram thresholds.
 - Concern that broad warning coverage could affect many products.



PRELIMS FACTS

- FSSAI is a statutory body under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.
 - Food labelling is a regulatory tool for consumer information.
 - NCD prevention involves diet, physical activity and public-health regulation.



MAINS ANGLE

Effective food regulation must balance consumer right to information, public-health goals, scientific evidence, regulatory certainty and proportional compliance costs.

- WATCH NEXT

 - Supreme Court observations
 - Final FSSAI thresholds

- Implementation timeline
 - Industry compliance rules

CURRENT AFFAIRS

DAILY DIGEST

10 SEPTEMBER 2026

POLITY & GOVERNANCE

Institutions • Rights • Reforms

ECONOMY

Growth • Markets • Financial Stability

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

India's partnerships • Global developments

ENVIRONMENT

Climate resilience • Sustainability

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Innovation • Research • Emerging technology

AGRICULTURE

Food security • Farmers • Rural development

NEW SEED LAW

INDIA MOVES TO CRACK DOWN ON FAKE & SUBSTANDARD SEEDS

Stronger laws for quality seeds, farmer protection and a more resilient agriculture sector.

BETTER
SEEDS
BRIGHTER
TOMORROWS



WHAT IS HAPPENING?

- Government is preparing a new **Seed Act**.
- Union Agriculture Minister is holding a nationwide consultation with major farmer organisations on **10 September 2026** at Krishi Bhawan before the legislation is finalised.
- Farmer experiences and suggestions will inform the draft.



WHY A NEW FRAMEWORK?

- Fake or poor-quality seed can cause **crop failure** and heavy income loss for farmers.
- Traceability and enforcement gaps weaken farmer protection.
- Reliable seed quality supports higher productivity and food security.



CORE IDEAS



Stringent action against fake, adulterated and substandard seeds.



Stronger seed-quality standards.



End-to-end traceability from production to sale.



Accountability of companies and traders.



Protection of farmers' traditional-seed rights.



SEED GOVERNANCE BASICS

- Regulation covers quality standards, labelling, sale and enforcement.
- Central and state institutions share implementation responsibilities.
- Plant-variety protection and farmers' rights are related but distinct from seed-quality regulation.



PRELIMS FACTS

- **Seeds Act, 1966** is a key existing seed-quality law.
- **Seeds (Control) Order, 1983** regulates seed dealers under the Essential Commodities framework.
- **Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Act, 2001** covers breeders' and farmers' rights.



AGRICULTURE LINK

- Quality seed is a foundational farm input.
- Genetic purity, germination, physical purity and seed health influence crop performance.
- Traceability can help quickly identify defective seed lots and prevent wider losses.

QUALITY
SEEDS
STRONGER
HARVESTS



MAINS ANGLE

Reform must balance farmer protection, innovation and investment, affordable access, biodiversity, traditional seed systems, testing capacity and enforceable accountability.



WATCH NEXT

- Draft bill text.
- Treatment of farmer-saved / traditional seed.
- Certification and registration rules.
- Penalties for violations.
- Traceability requirements.
- Parliamentary process.



QUALITY SEED



PRODUCTIVITY



FARM INCOME



FOOD SECURITY

MARITAL RAPE EXCEPTION — SUPREME COURT TO TEST CONSTITUTIONAL VALIDITY

Marriage does not extinguish individual autonomy:
Supreme Court to examine challenges to the marital rape exception.

WHAT HAPPENED?

- Supreme Court will **begin final hearing after about three weeks** on petitions challenging the marital rape exception.
- Challenges concern the exception under IPC and now under the BNS.
- Court will test whether the exception survives constitutional scrutiny.

WHAT DOES CURRENT LAW SAY?

- **Exception 2 to Section 63 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS)** excludes sexual acts by a man with his own wife from the offence of rape.
- The wife must **not be under 18 years** of age for the exception to apply.
- BNS replaced the IPC from **1 July 2024**.

COURT'S DILEMMA

- Court observed that individual **autonomy** continues within marriage.
- But can courts permit rape prosecution while Parliament has expressly retained an exception?
- The Court says the constitutionality of the exception must be examined.



"Marriage does not extinguish individual autonomy."

SUPREME COURT

PRELIMS FACTS

- **Section 63 BNS** defines rape and contains the marital exception.
- **Article 14** guarantees equality before law and equal protection.
- **Article 20(1)** protects against ex-post-facto criminal liability.
- **Article 21** protects life and personal liberty.



CORE CONSTITUTIONAL QUESTIONS

- Article 14** Equality before law and protection against arbitrariness.
- Article 21** Right to life, dignity, privacy and bodily autonomy.
- Article 20(1)** No conviction for an act that was not an offence under the law in force when committed.
- Separation of powers** Limits of judicial interpretation versus Parliament's law-making role.

IMPORTANT BACKGROUND

- Delhi High Court delivered a **split verdict** in 2022 on the marital rape exception.
- Karnataka High Court allowed prosecution of a husband in a case that is now before the Supreme Court.
- Supreme Court's 2017 **Independent Thought** judgment protected minor wives by reading the age threshold consistently with 18 years.

MAINS ANGLE

- Consent and bodily autonomy within marriage.
- Equality and protection from sexual violence.
- Misuse concerns and due-process safeguards.
- Institutional competence: judicial adjudication or legislative reform.

WATCH NEXT

- Final hearing before the Supreme Court.
- How the Court treats Section 63 exception.
- Outcome in the Karnataka appeal.
- Centre's arguments that criminalisation is for Parliament.
- Whether the Court strikes down, reads down or upholds the provision.

BRICS SUMMIT 2026

INDIA'S MULTILATERALISM & GLOBAL SOUTH AGENDA

12 – 13 SEPTEMBER 2026 | NEW DELHI, INDIA

10 SEPT 2026

LATEST
DEVELOPMENT

STRONGER
PARTNERSHIPS
A BRIGHTER,
MORE INCLUSIVE
WORLD

NEW DELHI
HOSTS
A STRONGER
GLOBAL SOUTH

DIALOGUE
DEVELOPMENT
A FAIRER WORLD

WHAT IS HAPPENING?



- India hosts the **18th BRICS Summit** in New Delhi on **12–13 September 2026**.
- Leaders will focus on **“Inclusive Global Governance and Strengthening Multilateralism”** in the opening closed session.

INDIA'S PRIORITIES



- Resilient supply chains
- Startups and innovation
- Green energy and sustainable development
- Practical cooperation for the Global South
- Reform of international institutions

WHAT IS BRICS?



- An intergovernmental/plurilateral grouping of major emerging economies.
- Decisions are **consensus-based**.
- Chairship rotates among members.
- Cooperation spans political-security, economic-financial and people-to-people areas.

WHY MULTILATERAL REFORM?



- Emerging economies seek a greater voice in institutions created under older global power structures.
- Key issues:** fairer representation, development finance and stronger responses to cross-border challenges like climate change, pandemics and food-energy security.

FINANCIAL COOPERATION



- Discussions include cross-border payments and greater use of national currencies in trade and settlements.
- Not the same as an imminent single BRICS currency.**
- Aim is to reduce transaction costs and enhance financial resilience.

NEW DEVELOPMENT BANK (NDB)



- Created by BRICS members in 2014 through the Fortaleza process.
- Headquartered in Shanghai, China.
- Finances infrastructure and sustainable-development projects in member and other developing countries.

INDIA'S BALANCING ROLE



- India supports a multipolar, reformed international order.
- Emphasis on strategic autonomy, consensus and practical development cooperation rather than bloc confrontation.

PRELIMS FACTS



- BRICS began with Brazil, Russia, India and China; South Africa joined later.
- NDB was established through the Fortaleza process in 2014.
- BRICS has no permanent secretariat like the UN.

MAINS ANGLE



BRICS gives India a platform to advance Global South priorities, institutional reform and development cooperation, but internal geopolitical differences and differing economic interests can limit collective action.

WATCH NEXT



- New Delhi summit declaration
- Language on UN/IMF reform
- Progress on payment systems and national currencies
- Supply-chain initiatives
- Green-energy cooperation
- Possibility of future expansion

A MORE
INCLUSIVE
TOMORROW

STRATEGIC AUTONOMY • MULTIPOLARITY • GLOBAL SOUTH • REFORMED MULTILATERALISM

AI BOOM & FINANCIAL STABILITY BIS FLAGS NEW RISKS

HUGE OPPORTUNITIES. REAL RISKS. A MORE COMPLEX GLOBAL ECONOMY.



WHAT HAPPENED?

- BIS head Pablo Hernández de Cos warns that the **AI investment boom** creates new financial-stability risks.
- Remarks made at an RBI-hosted conference in India.
- AI can boost productivity but may also amplify financial vulnerabilities.

SCALE OF THE BOOM

Top five global tech firms:

> \$1 trillion

AI infrastructure investment estimated for 2025–26.

Broader global AI investment could approach

\$4 trillion by 2030.

\$4T
by 2030

> \$1T
in 2025–26



WHY CENTRAL BANKS CARE

- AI simultaneously changes aggregate demand, productive capacity, labour markets, asset valuations and financing conditions.
- This makes inflation, growth and financial-risk assessment harder.



A MORE
INTERCONNECTED
AND COMPLEX
ECONOMY

FINANCIAL-STABILITY CHANNEL

- Large capital expenditure on AI infrastructure.
- Greater debt and private-credit financing.
- Opaque exposures can make leverage and risk concentration harder to monitor.
- Rapid asset-price expectations can reverse if returns disappoint.



DEBT &
PRIVATE CREDIT



HIGHER
LEVERAGE RISK

PRODUCTIVITY UPSIDE

- Generative AI can improve productivity in specific tasks such as coding and professional writing.
- Economy-wide gains depend on diffusion, complementary infrastructure, skills, competition and movement of workers/capital to productive uses.



HUMAN SKILLS
+ AI
HIGHER
PRODUCTIVITY

INDIA ANGLE

- India's digital public infrastructure and technology workforce create opportunities.
- Priorities include AI skills, compute and energy infrastructure, responsible finance, competition and worker transition.



SKILLS
INFRASTRUCTURE
INCLUSIVE GROWTH

PRELIMS FACTS

- BIS is an international organisation serving central banks and is headquartered in Basel, Switzerland.
- **Financial stability** means the financial system can perform core functions and absorb shocks.
- **Private credit** refers broadly to lending outside traditional public bond markets and often outside conventional bank lending channels.

MAINS ANGLE

- Policymakers must capture AI-driven productivity while guarding against leverage, concentration, labour displacement and unequal access. Innovation policy and macro-financial regulation need to evolve together.

WATCH NEXT

- AI investment financing
- Private-credit exposure
- Productivity data
- Labour-market effects
- Semiconductor supply chains
- Central-bank financial-stability assessments



AI PRODUCTIVITY + SOUND FINANCE + SKILLS = RESILIENT GROWTH



10 SEPT 2026

ASEAN-INDIA

AGRICULTURE PLAN 2026-2030

FOOD SECURITY, CLIMATE RESILIENCE & DIGITAL FARMING

Deepening cooperation for sustainable, resilient and inclusive agriculture across South and Southeast Asia

STRONGER FARMS
STRONGER REGION
BRIGHTER TOMORROW

PEOPLE
CROPS
PLANET
PROSPERITY
TOGETHER

SHARED SOLUTIONS
FOR A FOOD-SECURE AND RESILIENT TOMORROW



WHAT HAPPENED?

9th ASEAN-India Ministerial Meeting on Agriculture and Forestry held in New Delhi.

India and ASEAN backed stronger farmer-centred cooperation for 2026-2030.



CORE PRIORITIES (2026-2030)



Climate-resilient farming



Sustainable and low-emission agriculture (including rice systems)



Digital and AI-enabled agriculture



Joint research and innovation



Capacity building and farmer exchanges



Resilient food and agricultural supply chains



WHY IT MATTERS

- South and Southeast Asia face climate shocks, food-price volatility, pests, water stress and supply-chain disruption.
- Regional cooperation can share technology, germplasm, research and good practices.



RESILIENT
FARMS
STRONGER
PEOPLE



INDIA-ASEAN FRAMEWORK

- Agriculture and forestry cooperation sits within the ASEAN-India Comprehensive Strategic Partnership.
- Ministers welcomed ASEAN 2045: Our Shared Future and the ASEAN Food, Agriculture and Forestry Sectoral Plan 2026-2030.



A STRONGER
AND MORE PROSPEROUS
INDO-PACIFIC



GENE RESOURCES

- NBPGR is India's nodal institution for management of plant genetic resources.
- Germplasm conservation supports crop breeding, biodiversity and climate resilience.



CONSERVING
DIVERSITY
FOR A RESILIENT FUTURE



LOW-EMISSION RICE

- Rice cultivation can emit methane under flooded conditions.
- Improved water and crop-management practices can reduce emissions while maintaining productivity.



CLIMATE-SMART RICE
FOR A GREENER TOMORROW



PRELIMS FACTS

- ASEAN was established in 1967.
- Its Secretariat is in Jakarta.
- India is a dialogue partner, not an ASEAN member.
- ICAR is India's apex agricultural research body.
- NBPGR works on plant genetic resources.



MAINS ANGLE

Agricultural diplomacy can connect food security, climate adaptation, biodiversity, technology sharing and Global South cooperation, but implementation requires financing, farmer access and locally suitable technologies.



WATCH NEXT

- Projects under the 2026-2030 plan
- AI/digital agriculture cooperation
- Low-emission rice initiatives
- Germplasm and research exchanges
- Resilient regional food supply chains



FOOD SECURITY



CLIMATE RESILIENCE



INNOVATION



REGIONAL COOPERATION

THRIVING
FARMERS
STRONGER
TOMORROWS